Source: Wikimedia Commons

Therefore, at the beginning of 1947, Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan in Poonch, Lt. Col. Roger Bacon in Gilgit and Sheikh Abdullah and Prime Minister Kak in the valley, were positioned as the emerging poles of dissonance within the Maharaja's rule. For reasons best known to himself, Kak was pursuing a pro-Pakistan agenda and sought to irrevocably manoeuvre the Maharaja to accede to Pakistan. Lt. Col. Bacon's agenda was to preserve British interests at any cost and to achieve this, he had to hold on to the Gilgit Agency for the time being. Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan's agenda was to destroy the Maharaja's rule and lead Poonch to accede to Pakistan. Sheikh Abdullah's agenda was to overthrow the Maharaja and replace him. Nehru's agenda was to secure the entire state for the Indian Union, securing a land bridge for India's access to Central Asia and thereby also defying the two-nation theory [10].

The stage was set for all these people to play their cards in 1947.